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The future of the B2B e-commerce industry



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E-commerce technology has become a game-changer for B2C and B2B companies. B2B e-commerce is outpacing B2C and will soon outperform it. According to an IBEF report, the Indian e-commerce industry is growing, and it is expected to surpass the US to become the second-largest e-commerce market in the world by 2034. The rise in technology-enabled innovations like digital payments, hyper-local logistics, analytics-driven customer engagement and digital advertisements will be key strengths.

The growth in the e-commerce sector will also boost employment, increase revenues from export, increase tax collection by exchequers and provide better products and services to customers in the long term. According to Goldman Sachs, India's e-commerce market is one of the fastest-growing in the world, and it is projected to reach USD 99 billion by 2024.

B2B Growth Trends

The result is a changing landscape for B2B sales. Customers increasingly expect that online platforms have the same functionality as B2C businesses stores and provide a seamless, user-friendly experience that can be customized to their needs. Paired with the impact of COVID-19, B2B is quickly changing in this direction.

Businesses are moving to digital in the future. B2B marketers must embrace technology and related skillsets to push an increasingly online, sustainable marketplace. B2B sales are shifting towards an e-commerce focus, one that could learn from its B2C counterpart.

In the future, B2B e-commerce trends will be highly influenced by the increasingly digital workspace shaped by new technology and a reliance on data. These growth trends will enhance the presence of e-commerce in marketplaces, increasing sales across borders and overseas in an increasingly global marketplace. It will also create an impact on amplifying technology via data integration and unified analytics for improved products and marketing strategies. The increase in the use of AI tools will help in providing personalised product recommendations and chatbot assistance for a great customer experience. The development of mobile applications will bring user-friendly, omnichannel efficiency to B2B sales.

The Evolution of Business Sales

One of the most popular components of B2B sales is an operational online store. By bringing e-commerce to a B2B business model, companies are setting themselves up for success. While the appearance of an e-commerce B2B website is important, the site needs to maintain operational

efficiency, which corresponds to the overall business strategy.

The Future of B2B E-commerce

Despite the pandemic, the future of B2B e-commerce has a bright outlook. B2B companies are adding value to businesses of all types with technologies that make user-friendly, personalised e-commerce platforms possible. While the pandemic has required a shift in processes, B2B marketers can capitalise on the shift to offer streamlined services and maintain competitiveness in 2021 and beyond.

In the next 20 years, omnichannel presence will reign supreme, with customers demanding the ability to purchase from a brand, regardless of the channel, emphasising the importance of seamless customer engagement. Sustainability in businesses will lead to the rise of the circular economy due to consumer concerns about the environment. Emotional intelligence will become a core feature for brands, from neuromarketing to understanding customer needs and Artificial Intelligence will expect emotional intelligence to grow tremendously. Development in blockchain will enable the next generation of payment, inventory/asset management and auditing. It will also play a pivotal role in the supply chain. Supply chains will need to be transparent and ethical. Consumers will be more focused on where their items are sourced and will want to support brands that exhibit purpose. A more integrated IoT & blockchain will open new avenues of self/auto servicing supply chains.

B2B e-commerce should be focused on the digital supply chain, onboarding retailers and changing buying behaviour. In the long run, it will be driven by enhanced logistics efficiency, information-driven demand generation, improved capital cycles and shorter consumption cycles. There could also be tremendous opportunities for B2B e-commerce companies to introduce private-label products and have direct partnerships with manufacturing companies for further improving unit economics. **d**